

Sam and Dusty's big prairie adventure

Cowboy story • 3-4 years old



The sun was bright over the wide, golden prairie. Sam the cowboy rode his brown horse, Dusty. Sam wore a big hat, red scarf, and shiny boots. He liked to sing as he rode. "Giddy up, Dusty!" said Sam with a smile. The wind made the grass dance and the sky was big and blue.

Sam was going to the next town to bring a bag of shiny marbles for the children. He carried the marbles in his leather bag. "These marbles will make the children happy," said Sam. Dusty snorted, "Neigh!" as if he agreed.

Sam and Dusty rode along the dusty path. They saw tall green cacti, pretty yellow flowers, and funny prairie dogs that popped out of holes. Sam waved, "Howdy, prairie dogs!" The prairie dogs squeaked hello and popped back down.

After a while, Sam saw something ahead. There was a deep, rocky cliff. The edge was crumbly and didn't look safe. Sam stopped Dusty. He remembered what Mama always said, "Be brave, be smart, and take care."

Sam got off Dusty and looked at the cliff. The path was broken and the ground was soft. If they got too close, the edge might fall. Sam felt a little worried, but he took a deep breath. "We need to find a safe way, Dusty," he said.

Sam looked around. He saw an old path to the left, hidden by tall grass. Maybe it would lead around the cliff! Sam held Dusty's reins and led him slowly. "Let's go slow and careful," said Sam softly.

They moved one step at a time. The grass was thick, but Sam was gentle. He listened to the birds singing and felt the sun on his face. When a big rock blocked the way, Sam thought hard. He pulled the bridle loose and said, "Wait here, Dusty." Sam pushed the rock with all his strength. He pushed and pushed. At last, the rock rolled away. "Hooray!" Sam cheered.

Dusty neighed, "Good job!" Sam patted Dusty's nose. "Thank you, friend," he said. They kept walking, always looking for the sure path. The path was twisty and narrow, but Sam did not give up. He remembered, "Be brave, be smart, and take care." Sometimes Sam sang a little song to make things feel better. "We

are brave, we are strong, the trail is long, but we belong!”

Soon, Sam saw the cliff again, but now they were far from the crumbly edge. The sun made the rocks glow. “We did it, Dusty!” Sam said. Dusty nuzzled Sam with his soft nose.

Sam and Dusty reached the safe, wide path on the other side. They were tired but happy. “Thank you for being brave with me, Dusty,” said Sam. Dusty snorted and shook his mane.

Soon, Sam saw the roofs of the little town. The children ran to greet him. They waved and cheered. “Sam! Sam!” they called. Sam smiled and reached into his bag. He gave each child a shiny marble. The marbles sparkled in the sun. The children clapped and laughed.

Sam felt proud. He had been brave and smart. He took care of Dusty, and he did not give up. The wind was soft and warm now. The children played, and Sam sat in the grass with Dusty. He watched the clouds move across the sky.

Sam said quietly, “Every day can be an adventure if you are brave and kind.” Dusty neighed in agreement. The sun began to set, painting the sky orange and pink. Sam and Dusty rested, full of joy and peace, ready for a new day under the big, beautiful sky.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) Who is the cowboy in the story?

- Sam
- Mama
- Dusty
- Prairie dog

2) What is Dusty?

- horse
- dog
- cow
- bird

3) What did Sam bring for the children?

- marbles
- cookies
- hats
- books

4) What did Sam do when the path was broken?

- find a safe way
- jump off the cliff
- go to sleep
- run away

Correct answers:

1) Sam 2) horse 3) marbles 4) find a safe way

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Prairie: A wide, flat place with lots of grass and few trees.

Cowboy: A person who rides horses and works with animals on the land.

Marbles: Small, round glass balls that children play with.

Leather bag: A soft bag made from animal skin that holds things.

Cliff: A very steep, high edge of rock or land.

Crumbly: Something that breaks or falls apart into small pieces.

Reins: Long straps a rider holds to steer a horse.

Bridle: The head gear put on a horse to help control it.

Nuzzled: To gently push your face or nose against someone to show love.

Mane: The long hair along a horse's neck.

Prairie dogs: Small animals that live in the ground and pop up to look around.